HNG Internship 15 — Stage 1

AI Product Builder / Engineer · To-Do List Implementation Guide

Important

Source: This guide is based on the Stage 1 lesson video details provided from the HNG Drive lesson. The video-derived instructions should take priority over earlier screenshots or interpretations where they differ.

Deadline: The supplied video summary states Wednesday. Confirm the exact date/time from the official submission announcement in Zedu before submitting.

1. Assignment Requirements

Mandatory

- Create a To-Do List application.
- Include a notes feature.
- Include at least one additional feature.
- Code the application entirely using AI.
- Use any programming language, framework, or database setup you prefer.
- Deploy the application publicly so it has a live URL.
- Join an official HNG team.

Advanced requirements

- Create an **AGENTS.md** file in the repository.
- Use structured rules and instructions to guide the AI coding agent.
- Include testing/validation rules, such as tests for API endpoints.

2. Tools and Accounts

Tool / Platform	Purpose
Zedu	HNG workspace, announcements, teams, lessons and submission information.
AI coding agent	Generate, modify, debug and manage the application code.
GitHub	Store the application source code.
Vercel / Netlify / similar	Deploy the application publicly.
Telegram	Team communication.

3. Step-by-Step Implementation

1. Join a team

Open Zedu, go to the team-formation channel, choose/join an official team and enter the team's Telegram chat.

2. Choose an AI coding tool

Use a supported coding agent such as Claude Code, Codex, Gemini or another suitable agent. Use one tool consistently rather than moving prompts between multiple apps.

3. Create the To-Do app

Ask the coding agent to build a To-Do application with task creation, viewing, editing/updating, deletion, notes and at least one additional feature.

4. Run and test locally

Start the generated application locally. Test every required feature and tell the AI exactly what is broken or missing.

5. Create AGENTS.md

For the advanced requirement, create AGENTS.md at the project root and use it to define coding rules, conventions and validation/testing requirements.

6. Push to GitHub

Initialize Git if necessary, commit the project and push it to a GitHub repository. Team repositories may have additional requirements later.

7. Deploy

Connect the repository to Vercel, Netlify or another public host and generate a live URL.

8. Verify the live app

Open the public URL and test the core To-Do, notes and extra features online.

9. Submit

Use the official Stage 1 submission form published in Zedu and submit the live product URL before the official deadline.

4. AI Prompting Approach

The lesson emphasizes short, iterative instructions rather than one huge prompt. Build with the AI, run the result, observe what is wrong, and tell the agent what to fix.

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GitHub: "How do I get this into GitHub? Make it simple for beginners."
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AGENTS.md testing rule: "Write test for all the endpoints that you create and always validate
that these endpoints are working."
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AGENTS.md improvement: "Is there any other thing of note we should have in this file?"
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5. AGENTS.md

AGENTS.md acts as persistent project context for coding agents. It can define naming conventions, code style, architecture constraints, testing requirements and other rules the agent should follow across sessions.

For this assignment, an example requirement is that the agent should write tests for every API endpoint it creates and validate that those endpoints work.

6. GitHub and Deployment

GitHub: Keep the source code in a repository and make commits as you work. If you are unfamiliar with Git commands, the lesson demonstrates asking the AI agent to explain the process step by step.

Deployment: Connect the GitHub repository to a public hosting provider such as Vercel or Netlify. After deployment, test the live URL rather than assuming that a successful build means the application works correctly.

7. Submission

The supplied lesson notes state that the Stage 1 submission form will be published in the Zedu announcements / announcements-project channel and that the live public product URL is required.

8. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Leaving the application only on localhost instead of deploying it publicly.
- Missing the official submission announcement or deadline.
- Using prohibited/unrecommended builders mentioned in the lesson (such as Replit or Lovable Dev).
- Overcomplicating the AI prompting process instead of iterating with short, clear instructions.
- Failing to test the live deployment.
- Ignoring team and Zedu communication.

9. Stage 1 Final Checklist

- ■ Join an official HNG team.
- ■ Join the team's Telegram chat.
- ■ Choose an AI coding agent.
- ■ Build the To-Do List using AI.
- ■ Implement task management.
- ■ Implement notes.
- ■ Implement at least one additional feature.
- ■ Test the app locally.
- ■ Create AGENTS.md (advanced).
- ■ Add testing/validation rules (advanced).
- ■ Push the project to GitHub.
- ■ Deploy the app publicly.
- ■ Test the live URL.
- ■ Find the official submission form in Zedu.
- ■ Submit the live product URL before the confirmed deadline.

Prepared as a practical team-sharing guide from the supplied HNG Stage 1 lesson information. Always verify final deadline and submission instructions against the latest official Zedu announcement.